KITCHENS FOR GOOD

MURAL PROJECT PRESENTATION

The Kitchens for Good Mural

Up-Grade Members

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KITCHENS FOR GOOD

Our Team



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UI/UX Designer



Erin Law

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Visual Designer

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Mentor & NPO Point-of-Contact



Process & Timeline

Weeks 1-2

- Onboarding
- Ideation & Initial Research

Weeks 3-5

- Collaboration with the KfC Redesign Team
- Analyzed & applied interview insights
- UI/UX Competitive Analysis Research

Weeks 6-8

- Mural & UI/UX Lo-fi & Mid-fi iterations
- Additional UI/UX Research

Weeks 9-10

- Mural Hi-fi
- Web animation testing & deployment
- Case study & presentation preparations

BACKGROUND

About our NPO: Kitchens for Good

Kitchens for Good is a San Diego nonprofit that **transforms lives** through culinary arts and apprenticeship programs.

Our team was tasked to **design a mural** for their upcoming HQ that represents growth and knowledge-sharing across their whole mission.





"Transforming lives through culinary arts."

How can we create a mural design for the Kitchens for Good community in order to empower apprentices, staff members, and the general public by conveying the non-profit’s core values?

BACKGROUND

What We’re Designing Around

"Transforming lives through culinary arts."

Equity

“Operate in a way that is fair, accessible and welcoming to all.”

Human Service

Work with “ dignity, structure, encouragement, and accountability

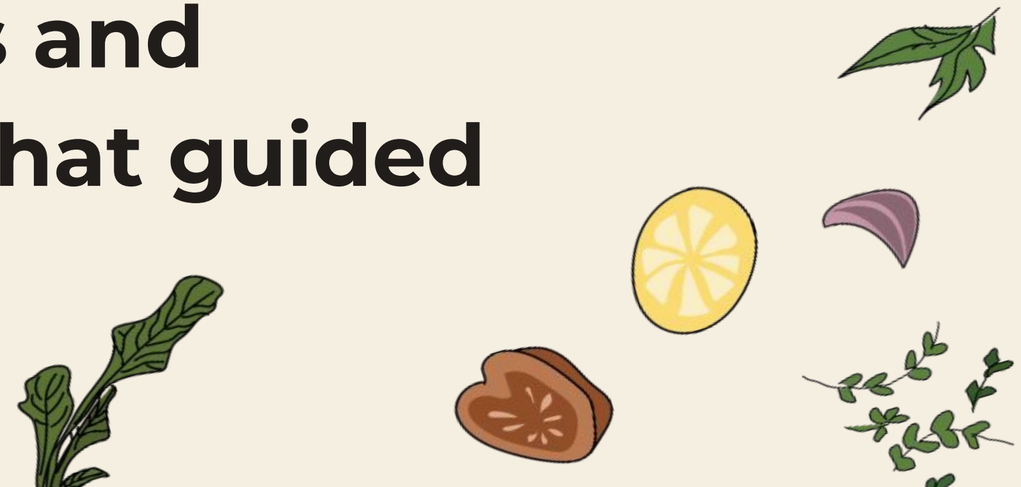
Growth Mindset

“Foster a culture of innovation, continuous improvement and learning.”

Sustainability

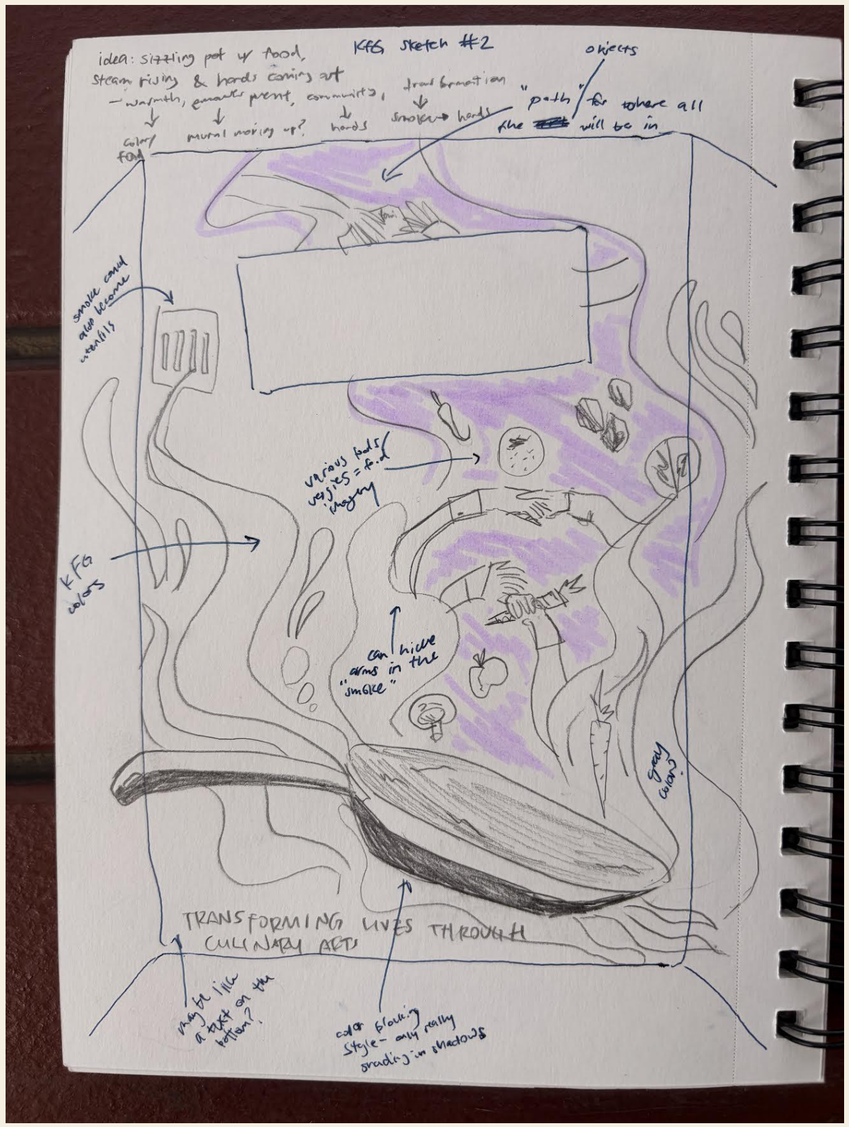
Generate economic value while simultaneously “improving social and environmental outcomes.”

Core values and principles that guided the project



Ideation

The Design Concept: Lo-fis & Mid-fis



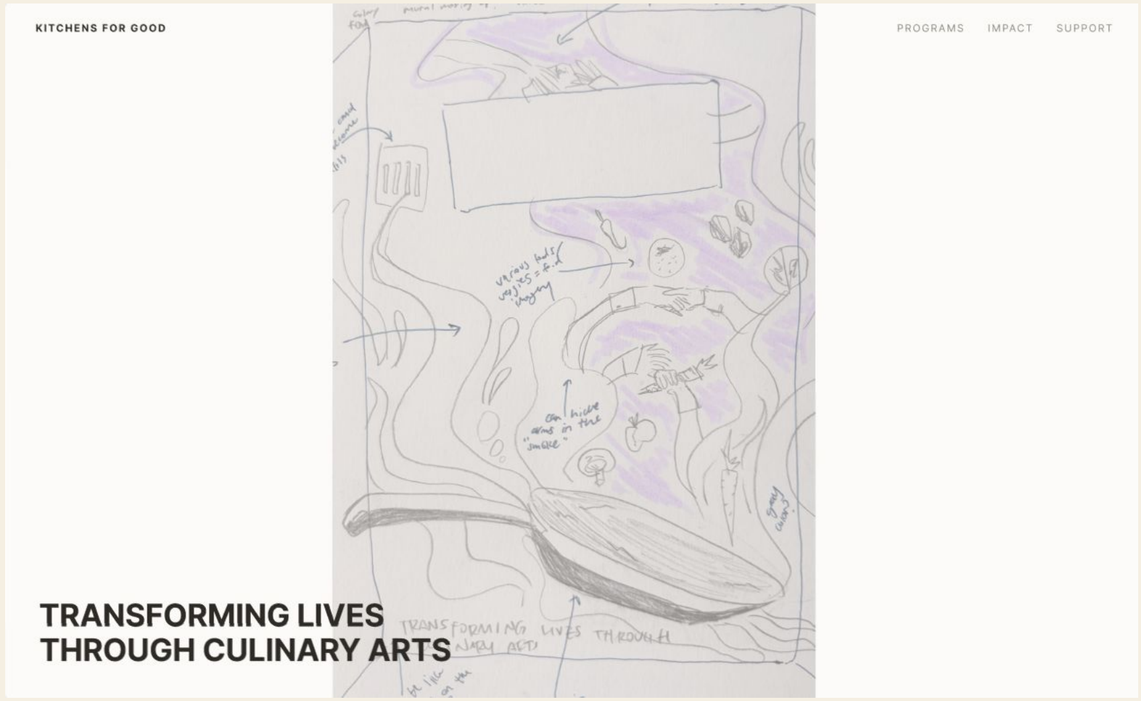




Ideation

The Design Concept: Lo-fis & Mid-fis





Research

User Interviews

8 interviews across community members, apprentices, and staff

01 How should it feel?

Warmth
Empowerment
Safety
Community
Transformation
Vibrant
Uplifting

02 Who is it for?

3/8 Community First
2/8 Apprentice-First
3/8 Both

03 What should we see?

2/8 Food and Craft
3/8 People
3/8 Both



Research

Competitive Analysis

KFG Research

	Type + Example	Approach	Strengths	Transferable to KFG	Gap/Limitation
"Take the Risk to Cool Down" mural, New Haven	*Mural (mission + impact)* Link Link 	*Artist Victoria Martínez painted a cooling mural on the building housing MATCH, a workforce development hub; it was unveiled in October 2023 alongside MATCH's first cohort of manufacturing students and municipal/state officials.*	*Milestone event tied to a specific cohort's graduation, so it serves not just as decor but a specific moment in a group's journey.*	*KFG could tie the mural reveal to a specific program or KFG milestone*	*Purely visual — no digital/interactive layer*
Collaboration Zone mural	*Mural (community facing)* Link 	*The foundation hired artist collective Girls Who Paint Murals to depict the specific counties/regions the org serves; the space opened in Jan 2023 and hosts nonprofit training programs, collaboration events, and donor gatherings.*	*Milestone event tied to a specific cohort's graduation, so it serves not just as decor but a specific moment in a group's journey.*	*KFG's hallway mural could map to specific San Diego neighborhoods/communities served by its meal programs, so donors and community cafe visitors immediately see who/what this nonprofit is here for.*	*Budget? (we should probably ask/figure out how to calculate with the painting supplies and time)*
Mailchimp Atlanta HQ murals	*Mural (internal culture)* Link	*Mailchimp commissioned artist Christopher Derek Bruno for bold/clean graphic murals, working through the nonprofit Living Walls to connect with a local Atlanta artist.*	*Working through a nonprofit-artist-matching org (Living Walls) gave Mailchimp access to a local artist within the community*	*KFG could look for a similar local-artist-matching nonprofit in San Diego to source a muralist with ties to the food/community-service, reinforcing authenticity*	
CodeVA / Performing Statistics mural, Richmond	*Interactive (sensors + AR)* Link	*Students turned their mural, + videos, poems, and radio broadcasts, into an AR installation: distance sensors made audio and lights blink as viewers got closer, and a QR code opened an AR layer showing the mural-making process and linking to partner orgs Rise for Youth and Performing Statistics.*	*Specifically shows the making of the piece and routes people to the partner organizations' missions*	*A QR code that opens to website/ information page/ what you need to know - a short video of apprentices talking about the mural's meaning, then links to KFG's programs/donation page...*	*Distance-sensor lighting/audio setup adds real installation cost and maintenance* *QR-to-web piece is more realistic*
Adel, Iowa AR mural	*Interactive (QR + AR, updatable)* Link 	*VAEZR Studio and Lashier Graphics built an AR-activated mural where the physical painting stayed fixed, but the QR-triggered digital "activation" content was swapped multiple times for different events.*	*The mural doesn't need repainting to stay current, only the digital layer behind the QR code needs updating for a new season, cohort, or campaign.*	*Refresh the linked web content ex/ swap in a new class of apprentices' stories each program cycle* *...without new construction cost.*	*Content-swapping requires someone on staff to own and update the digital side regularly*
BrandXR-style AR murals (general pattern)	*Interactive (QR/AR, low-lift)* Link Link	*Signage near the mural reads "Make this Mural Come Alive"; scanning the QR code opens a web-based AR viewer (no app download) that recognizes the mural via camera and layers animation on top.*	*Works through any phone's browser, which matters for a nonprofit audience (donors, families, walk-in cafe guests) who won't download a one-off app.*	*Realistic for KFG: a QR near the mural linking to a simple mobile web page (photos, a short apprentice story, a "support our programs" link)*	*Image-tracking accuracy varies with lighting conditions → Unrealistic* *QR Code integration*

KEY INSIGHTS

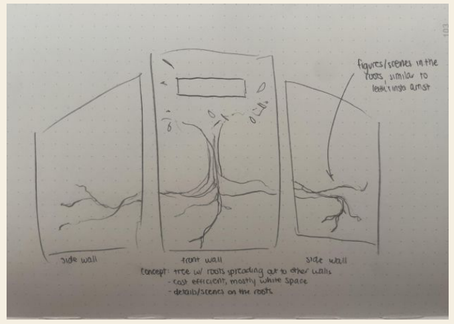
- **Interactive approaches vary widely** (QR codes, websites, AR, and physical installations)
- **More immersive ≠ always more effective.** AR and physical interactions can add complexity, cost, and maintenance.
- **The opportunity:** keep the mural visually engaging while using digital interaction to provide more depth.
- **Our direction:** a QR-connected informational website

Ideation

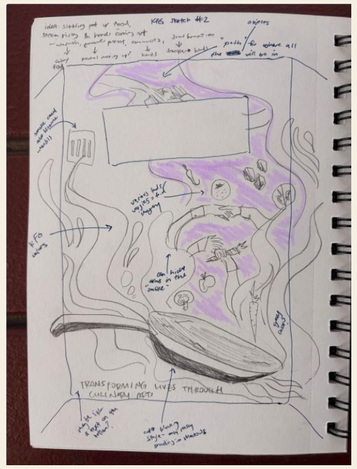
Key Insights from Mentor

Multiple iterations:

- Gave us inspiration images
- Liked the idea of it being a single painting
- Feedback on our sketches, colors, direction

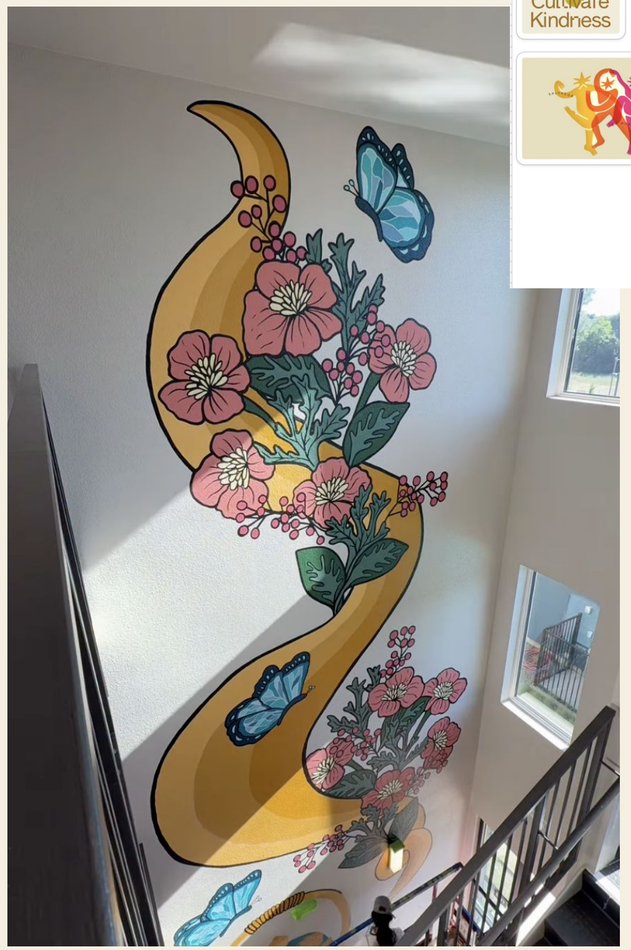


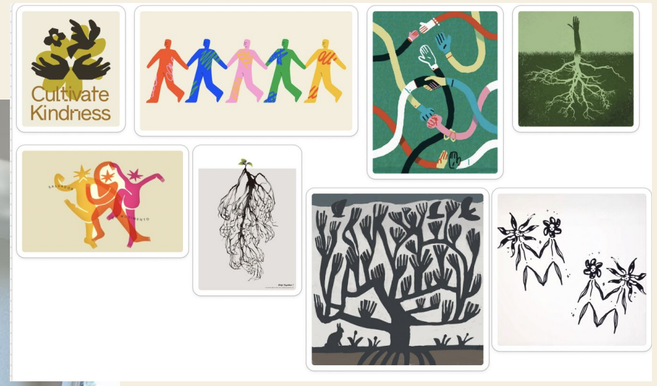
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Final Product

The Mural

Hi-fi Illustrator version – cleaned up lines, added finishing details.



Final Product

Design Choices & Rationale

Fire & smoke

- represents KFG core values – warmth, empowerment, community, transformation

Hands

- passing business permit/certificate: KFG micro-enterprise program and employer partners
- passing food: KFG meal contract program
- passing kitchenware: KFG shop
- passing chef’s hat: KFG apprenticeship program

Fruits & vegetables

- To keep the messaging timeless and relate back to food and culinary arts

Sizzling pan

- Representing the action and determination of KFG employees and apprentices



Final Product

The Website



Final Product

The Website – Interactive Mural



Reflection

The Journey

Team Growth

Our team’s biggest growth came from learning to better work together on separate projects, while maintaining a unified vision.

Some tasks depended deliverables. This forced us to work in parallel and step-by-step to ensure we stayed on schedule.



Looking Forward

Next Steps

Location	**KFG HQ**
Dimensions	**[12 ft × 23.2 ft]**

Team Growth

Our design is on track to be proposed to the Kitchens for Good’s Board or Directors for approval.

We also discussed plans for next year when the new space opens. There could potentially be open spots to physically paint the mural if and when it gets approved.

